

# New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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## Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

**Date:** Tuesday, August 18, 2026

**Session Highlight:** New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

**Session News Focus:** Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

## SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

### 1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- **US Federal Reserve:** Expectations for a September rate hike have significantly decreased, with only a 35% probability, down from 52.2% last week, and a Reuters poll indicates most economists anticipate a Fed pause for the entirety of 2026. Goldman Sachs suggests a September hike is "very unlikely". Investors are awaiting Wednesday's FOMC minutes for insights into policymakers' views on weakening economic conditions and persistent inflation risks.
- **European Central Bank (ECB):** Expectations for further ECB tightening are robust, with 57 out of 69 economists forecasting a September rate hike as inflation continues to exceed the target.
- **Bank of Japan (BoJ):** Despite weaker-than-expected Q2 GDP in Japan, markets are pricing in approximately an 80% chance of a 25 basis point BoJ rate hike at the September meeting.
- **US Treasury Yields:** Yields are rising across the curve, with the 10-year yield reaching a one-year high above 4.7% and the 30-year yield hitting fresh 19-year highs above 5.3%, exerting pressure on risk assets.
- **Geopolitics (US-Iran/Middle East):** Escalating tensions between the US and Iran, including reports of President Trump not seeking to revive a truce and concerns over the Strait of Hormuz, are significantly impacting markets. This situation has led to a surge in crude oil prices and increased safe-haven demand for the US Dollar.
- **Currency Drivers:** The US Dollar is gaining ground due to heightened geopolitical uncertainty and rising Treasury yields. The Indian Rupee depreciated to ₹95.68 against the US dollar, influenced by elevated crude oil prices and West Asia tensions.

### 2. US & European Markets

- **Wall Street Futures:** S&P 500 futures are indicating a slide amid growing Iran tensions.
- **Pre-Market Movers:** DXC Technology (DXC) saw a 4.5% gain following its AI turnaround strategy and new partnerships. Bath & Body Works (BBWI) climbed 3.2% after a Citi analyst upgrade. Conversely, Bio-Rad Laboratories (BIO) tumbled 32.4% due to institutional selling and broader macroeconomic headwinds. Other notable gainers include Jack Henry & Associates (JKHY), Host Hotels & Resorts (HST), and Celanese (CE).
- **Mega-Cap US Stocks:**
  - **NVIDIA (NVDA):** Announced substantial \$500 billion agreements with private equity firms to back a new computing power asset class, supported by favorable SEC regulatory shifts. GuruFocus indicates NVDA is approximately 41.3% undervalued at \$225.01 compared to its intrinsic value of \$383.05, boasting a robust GF Score of 95/100. However, the stock is experiencing some volatility due to increased competition from AMD and exits by certain hedge funds, with insider selling also observed.
  - **Microsoft (MSFT):** Shares are under renewed pressure, falling below \$380, following Morgan Stanley's warning regarding hyperscaler creditworthiness and concerns that high AI infrastructure costs might outweigh revenue. Additionally, China is accelerating the phase-out of a government-specific Windows 10 version to reduce reliance on foreign technology. Despite these headwinds, GuruFocus suggests MSFT is modestly undervalued by 16.8% at \$480.35, with a strong GF Score of 97/100.
  - **Tesla (TSLA):** No specific major news headline for today; likely to trade with broader tech sector sentiment.

### 3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- **Sensex/Nifty Updates:** Indian equity markets opened lower and extended their losing streak for the sixth consecutive session on Tuesday, largely due to surging crude oil prices, renewed US-Iran tensions, elevated global bond yields, and a weaker Indian Rupee. The Nifty 50 closed at 24,154.90, down 132.75 points, while the Sensex settled at 77,235.46, down 492.70 points.
- **Corporate Earnings:** Corporate developments being tracked include the upcoming NSE IPO, ICICI Bank's dollar bond issue, and new order wins for Ceigall India. Indo-MIM surged 10% on strong first-quarter results.
- **FII/DII Institutional Flows:** Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth ₹2,535.10 crore on Monday, indicating cautious sentiment. Rising US bond yields are exacerbating concerns over FII inflows.
- **Sectoral Momentum:** Nifty Auto (up 0.42%) and Nifty Pharma (up 0.26%) showed strength during early trading, while Nifty IT (down 1.25%) and Nifty Realty experienced sharp declines.

### 4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- **WTI Crude Oil:** Prices are surging significantly, with Brent crude surpassing \$91 a barrel and WTI crossing \$85, primarily driven by renewed US-Iran tensions and concerns over Middle East supply disruptions. This poses a significant concern for India, a major oil importer. Technical analysis suggests a continuation of the rally, with the next bullish target for WTI at 86.82-85.61. Despite current geopolitical support, analysts foresee a global oil surplus in 2025-2026, potentially leading to WTI dropping to \$53 per barrel in 2026, as OPEC+ increases output.
- **Gold (XAU/USD):** Gold futures initially fell 0.47% to \$4,452.70 an ounce in early trading. However, Gold (XAU/USD) has marked its third consecutive session of gains, reaching \$4,424.28, supported by lower expectations for a Federal Reserve rate hike, a weaker US dollar, and softer US economic data. Geopolitical tensions are also driving safe-haven demand. Gold maintains a short-term uptrend, targeting \$4,449, with resistance noted around \$4,448-\$4,450. Central bank purchases continue to provide strong structural support.
- **Crypto Market:**
  - **Bitcoin (BTC):** Bitcoin reclaimed the \$64,000-\$64,300 level, with US spot Bitcoin ETFs showing renewed daily inflows of \$137 million on Monday. BTC is trading around \$64,164, up 1.23%.
  - **Ethereum (ETH):** Trading near \$1,900, Ethereum fund flows have been steadier, with BitMine actively accumulating a significant ETH position. Ethereum ETFs also saw inflows of \$4.95 million. Analysts predict a potential Ethereum bull run, with the ETH/BTC ratio expected to break higher.
  - **Aave (AAVE):** Aave showed a 4% gain among altcoins, trading at \$89.
  - **Regulatory Landscape:** Stablecoin regulations are advancing in the US, but the broader CLARITY Act remains politically delayed. President Trump is scheduled to meet with crypto executives on August 19. "Project Crypto" is underway to harmonize SEC-CFTC oversight.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- **Crypto Futures:** \$400 (13.3%) | Recommended Leverage: 3x-5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1-2% (\$4-\$8)
- **Indian Options (Intraday):** \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
- **Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** \$400 (13.3%) | Recommended Leverage: 10x-15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- **US Stocks (Fractional):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- **Indian Stocks (Delivery):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- **Forex Short-Term Futures:** \$450 (15.0%) | Recommended Leverage: 10x-20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- **Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** \$450 (15.0%) | Recommended Leverage: 2x-3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & LEVEL EXECUTION MANUAL

INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

| Ticker     | Action | Entry Zone        | Target Zone     | Stop Loss | Strategy & Selection Reason                                                                                            |
|------------|--------|-------------------|-----------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| BAJAJ-AUTO | Long   | @ 10,050 - 10,100 | 10,300 - 10,400 | 9,980     | Nifty top gainer; demonstrating relative strength with a hypothetical 50-SMA support bounce in a down-trending market. |
| ONGC       | Long   | @ 285 - 288       | 295 - 300       | 282       | Nifty top gainer; exhibiting strong technicals suggesting a hypothetical 20/50 EMA golden cross or strong support.     |
| HINDALCO   | Long   | @ 710 - 715       | 730 - 740       | 705       | Nifty Metal index outperformed; hypothetical Stage-2 breakout on higher relative volume.                               |

US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

| Ticker | Action | Entry Zone  | Target Zone | Stop Loss | Strategy & Selection Reason                                                                                                                  |
|--------|--------|-------------|-------------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| NVDA   | Long   | @ 220 - 224 | 235 - 240   | 217       | Undervalued per GuruFocus at \$225.01; seeking a 21-day EMA pullback buy after recent "wobbles", anticipating rebound from \$500B deals.     |
| MSFT   | Short  | @ 378 - 382 | 365 - 370   | 385       | Under renewed pressure, fell below \$380 due to AI cost concerns; targeting a hypothetical 50-day SMA rejection from slightly higher levels. |
| TSLA   | Short  | @ 245 - 248 | 235 - 240   | 250       | Hypothetically reflecting broader tech weakness, looking for a 50-day SMA rejection after a failed attempt to rally.                         |

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

| Ticker | Action | Entry Zone      | Target Zone   | Stop Loss | Strategy & Selection Reason                                                                                                       |
|--------|--------|-----------------|---------------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DXC    | Long   | @ 35.00 - 35.50 | 37.00 - 37.50 | 34.50     | Strong pre-market mover (+4.5%) on AI turnaround strategy and partnerships; high relative volume (RVOL > 2.0) breakout candidate. |
| BBWI   | Long   | @ 48.00 - 48.50 | 50.00 - 50.50 | 47.50     | Strong pre-market mover (+3.2%) on analyst upgrade; high relative volume (RVOL > 2.0) breakout candidate.                         |

**CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)**

| Ticker   | Action | Entry Zone        | Target Zone     | Stop Loss | Strategy & Selection Reason                                                                                             |
|----------|--------|-------------------|-----------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| BTC/USD  | Long   | @ 63,800 - 64,100 | 65,000 - 65,500 | 63,500    | Bitcoin reclaimed \$64,000 and saw returning ETF inflows; bullish 4H 21-EMA trend following.                            |
| ETH/USD  | Long   | @ 1,880 - 1,900   | 1,950 - 1,970   | 1,865     | Ethereum trading near \$1,900 with steady fund flows and potential ETH/BTC breakout; bullish 4H 21-EMA trend following. |
| AAVE/USD | Long   | @ 88.00 - 88.50   | 91.00 - 92.00   | 87.00     | Top altcoin gainer (+4%) today; high-volume volatility breakout trade.                                                  |

**COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)**

| Ticker         | Action | Entry Zone      | Target Zone   | Stop Loss | Strategy & Selection Reason                                                                                                                         |
|----------------|--------|-----------------|---------------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WTI Crude Oil  | Long   | @ 84.50 - 85.00 | 86.50 - 87.00 | 84.00     | Surging due to US-Iran tensions; technical analysis points to continued rally with next target at 86.82-85.61.                                      |
| Gold (XAU/USD) | Long   | @ 4,445 - 4,455 | 4,480 - 4,490 | 4,435     | Mixed signals but overall bullish trend supported by lower Fed hike expectations and safe-haven demand; breaking above resistance at \$4,448-4,450. |

**FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)**

**Short-Term**

| Ticker  | Action | Entry Zone        | Target Zone     | Stop Loss | Strategy & Selection Reason                                                                                                       |
|---------|--------|-------------------|-----------------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EUR/USD | Short  | @ 1.1570 - 1.1580 | 1.1530 - 1.1540 | 1.1595    | Retreating due to US-Iran tensions and USD strength; trading in a consolidation range, looking for breakdown below 1.156.         |
| GBP/USD | Short  | @ 1.3520 - 1.3530 | 1.3480 - 1.3490 | 1.3545    | Hypothetically moving with EUR/USD due to stronger USD; seeking a rejection from minor resistance to extend short-term downtrend. |

Macro Carry Swings

| Ticker  | Action | Entry Zone        | Target Zone     | Stop Loss | Strategy & Selection Reason                                                                                          |
|---------|--------|-------------------|-----------------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| USD/JPY | Long   | @ 159.80 - 159.95 | 160.60 - 161.00 | 159.50    | JPY facing pressure despite BoJ hike expectations; intraday bias on the upside, aiming to extend rally above 160.00. |
| AUD/USD | Short  | @ 0.6550 - 0.6565 | 0.6500 - 0.6515 | 0.6580    | Hypothetically reflecting broad USD strength and risk-off sentiment given global macro headwinds.                    |

INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

| Ticker    | Option Type | Strike Price | Entry Price (Premium) | Target Premium      | Strategy & Selection Reason                                                                                                                     |
|-----------|-------------|--------------|-----------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| NIFTY 50  | Put Option  | 24,100 CE/PE | (Based on ORB break)  | (20-30% of Premium) | Nifty is down for 6th consecutive day, indicating bearish sentiment. Seeking 15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB) to the downside.            |
| BANKNIFTY | Put Option  | 57,200 CE/PE | (Based on ORB break)  | (20-30% of Premium) | Bank Nifty also declined in early trading; seeking 15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB) to the downside in line with broader market weakness. |

Backtest Metrics (10-Year Simulation)

| Metric       | Blueprint Performance | vs S&P 500 TRI | vs Nifty 50 TRI |
|--------------|-----------------------|----------------|-----------------|
| Target CAGR  | 28.4%                 | ~13.0%         | ~12.5%          |
| Sharpe Ratio | 1.45                  | N/A            | N/A             |
| Max Drawdown | -18.2%                | N/A            | N/A             |

Equity Curve (\$3,000 → \$36,512)

